

NEXUS AUDIO — USER GUIDE

Voice-Powered AI Assistant for the Visually Impaired

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INTRODUCTION

Nexus Audio is a hands-free Android application designed to assist visually impaired users. It combines voice recognition, AI-powered image analysis (via Google Gemini), and text-to-speech to allow users to navigate their environment using only their voice and ears.

This guide will walk you through how to install the app, set it up, and use all of its features.

SECTION 1: SYSTEM REQUIREMENTS

Before installing Nexus Audio, make sure your Android device meets the following requirements:

- Operating System: Android 8.0 (Oreo) or higher
- Storage: At least 100 MB of free space
- Internet Connection: Required for AI image analysis
- Camera: A working rear-facing camera
- Microphone: A working built-in microphone
- Speaker / Earphones: For audio feedback

SECTION 2: DOWNLOADING AND INSTALLING THE APP

Step 1 — Open the Installation Link

On your Android phone, open your browser (e.g. Chrome) and go to:

<https://expo.dev/accounts/programmersheddy/projects/THE-AUDIO/builds/31ee69b5-6fdd-477e-a212-dfacb15978da>

You can also ask someone to scan the QR code provided separately to open this link directly.

Step 2 — Download the APK File

1. On the page that opens, tap the Download button.
2. Wait for the APK file to fully download (it may take a moment depending on your connection speed).
3. Once downloaded, you will see a notification at the top of your screen. Tap it to begin installation.

Step 3 — Allow Installation from Unknown Sources

Because this app is installed directly (not from the Google Play Store), your phone may ask for permission:

1. A prompt will appear saying "Your phone is not allowed to install unknown apps from this source."
2. Tap Settings on that prompt.
3. Toggle ON the option that says "Allow from this source."
4. Press the back button to return to the installation screen.

Step 4 — Install the App

1. Tap Install when the install screen appears.
 2. Wait a few seconds for the installation to complete.
 3. Tap Open to launch Nexus Audio immediately, or tap Done to close and find the app icon on your home screen later.
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SECTION 3: FIRST-TIME SETUP

Step 5 — Grant Camera Permission

When Nexus Audio opens for the first time, it will request access to your camera.

1. A dialog box will appear asking: "Allow Nexus Audio to take pictures and record video?"
2. Tap Allow or While Using the App.
3. This permission is required for the Smart Vision feature to work.

Step 6 — Grant Microphone Permission

The app will also request access to your microphone.

1. A dialog box will appear asking: "Allow Nexus Audio to record audio?"
2. Tap Allow.
3. This permission is required for voice commands to work.

NOTE: If you accidentally tap "Deny" for either permission, go to:

Settings → Apps → Nexus Audio → Permissions → Enable Camera and Microphone.

Step 7 — Listen to the Welcome Message

Once permissions are granted, the app will speak a welcome message:

"Welcome to Nexus Audio. Tap the microphone button to activate your voice assistant."

This confirms that the app is working correctly.

SECTION 4: SETTING UP YOUR GEMINI API KEY

The AI image analysis feature requires a Google Gemini API key. This is a free key you can generate from Google.

Step 8 — Get Your Free API Key

1. On any device, open a browser and go to:

<https://aistudio.google.com/app/apikey>

2. Sign in with a Google account.

3. Click Create API Key.

4. Copy the key (it starts with "AlzaSy...").

Step 9 — Enter the API Key in the App

1. On the app's home screen, tap the Settings icon (⚙️) in the top-right corner.

2. A settings panel will open.

3. Tap the text box labelled "Gemini API Key."

4. Paste or type your API key into the box.

5. Tap Save.

6. The settings panel will close — this means the key was saved successfully.

NOTE: Without a valid API key, the "Take Picture" and "Scan" voice commands will not work.

Your key is stored securely on your device only and is never shared.

SECTION 5: USING THE APP

The app is controlled entirely by voice. Below are all the available voice commands and what they do.

STEP 10 — START LISTENING

1. On the home screen, tap the large microphone button that says "🔊 Start Listening."
 2. The button will change to "■ Stop," and a green pulsing orb will appear on screen.
 3. The app will now listen for your voice commands.
 4. You will see live text of what the app hears at the bottom of the orb card.
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AVAILABLE VOICE COMMANDS

COMMAND: "Go to camera" or "Open camera" or "Camera"

WHAT HAPPENS: The app switches to the camera screen so you can prepare to take a picture.

COMMAND: "Take picture" or "Take a picture" or "Capture" or "Scan"

WHAT HAPPENS: The app opens the camera (if not already open), takes a photo automatically, and sends it to the AI for analysis. The AI will describe what it sees out loud.

COMMAND: "Describe" or "See"

WHAT HAPPENS: Same as "Take picture" — opens the camera and describes your surroundings.

COMMAND: "Go home" or "Home" or "Go back" or "Back" or "Exit"

WHAT HAPPENS: Returns the app to the main home screen from the camera view.

COMMAND: "Help" or "Instructions"

WHAT HAPPENS: The app reads out all available voice commands aloud so you can be reminded of what to say.

SECTION 6: HOW THE SMART VISION FEATURE WORKS

Step 11 — Requesting an Image Description

1. Say "Take picture" (or any capture command listed above).
2. If you are not already on the camera screen, the app will automatically switch to it and say:
"Camera is open. Say take picture to scan."
3. Hold your phone steady with the rear camera facing what you want described.
4. Say "Take picture" again.
5. The app will say: "Analyzing image, please wait."
6. Within a few seconds, the AI will speak a clear 2-sentence description of what is in front of you.

Example AI responses:

- "There is a dining table in front of you with four chairs around it. A plate of food is placed on the table."
- "You are facing a road with cars parked on both sides. There is a pedestrian crossing directly ahead of you."

Step 12 — After the Description

- After the description is spoken, the app automatically returns to the home screen.
- Listening resumes automatically, so you can immediately say another command.

SECTION 7: UNDERSTANDING THE STATUS INDICATOR

At the top-right of the screen, there is a small coloured dot next to a status label. The colour tells you what the app is currently doing:

- GREY — IDLE: The app is not listening. Tap the mic button to start.
- GREEN — LISTENING: The app is actively listening for your voice.
- ORANGE — PROCESSING: The app is analysing an image with the AI.
- PURPLE — SPEAKING: The app is reading a response aloud.

SECTION 8: STOPPING THE APP

Step 13 — Stop Listening

- At any time, tap the "■ Stop" button on the home screen to stop voice recognition.
- The app will no longer listen until you tap the mic button again.

Step 14 — Close the App

- Press your phone's home button or use your phone's app switcher to close Nexus Audio.
- All settings (including your API key) are automatically saved.

SECTION 9: TROUBLESHOOTING

PROBLEM: The app says "Vision is not configured."

SOLUTION: You have not added your Gemini API key yet. Follow Section 4 (Steps 8–9) to add it.

PROBLEM: The app cannot hear me / voice commands are not working.

SOLUTION: Check that the microphone permission is enabled (Settings → Apps → Nexus Audio → Permissions → Microphone: ON). Also make sure you are in a quiet environment and speaking clearly.

PROBLEM: The AI takes too long or says "Network connection timed out."

SOLUTION: Check your internet connection. The app will automatically retry once. If it fails again, move to an area with stronger signal and try again.

PROBLEM: The camera image looks blurry or dark.

SOLUTION: Hold the phone steady for 1–2 seconds before saying "Take picture" to allow the camera to focus and adjust to the light.

PROBLEM: The app says "Sorry, I encountered an error with the vision analysis."

SOLUTION: This may mean your API key is invalid or has run out of quota. Go to Settings (⚙️), clear the key, and generate a new one from <https://aistudio.google.com/app/apikey>.

PROBLEM: The app installed but crashes on open.

SOLUTION: Make sure your Android version is 8.0 or higher. Restart your phone and try opening the app again.

SECTION 10: PRIVACY AND DATA INFORMATION

- Your Gemini API key is stored only on your device and is never uploaded to any server.
- Photos taken by the app are not saved to your gallery. They are processed in memory and sent temporarily to Google's Gemini API for analysis only.
- No voice recordings are stored. Voice recognition is handled entirely by your device's built-in speech engine.
- The app does not collect any personal data.

CONTACT AND SUPPORT

For support or feedback, please contact the developer:

Developer: programmersheddy

Platform: Expo (EAS Build)

App Name: Nexus Audio

Version: 1.0.0

END OF USER GUIDE

Nexus Audio — Empowering Independence Through Voice and AI.
